

Invitation

Border Security Force Communication and IT Directorate, CGO Complex, New Delhi, is a subscriber to EFY magazine. The articles published in EFY are very educative and these are passed on to technical staff in the ranks of DIGs, commandants and deputy commandants. On behalf of the directorate, we invite writers of such topics as new telecom services on the way, WiFi and WiMAX, 3G audio management and telemedicine to deliver lectures at our headquarter.

B.S. Kushwah, DIG
Through e-mail

EFY-CD Content

Many thanks for providing Ubuntu operating system in the EFY-CD of January issue. It's a very good operating system. Please publish some software and circuit diagrams for programming the Atmel microcontroller under Ubuntu operating system.

Subrat Kumar Mallik
Through e-mail

☐ Please include:

1. Free software like OCR in the EFY-CD.
2. Buyers' guide on car stereos in the magazine.

Jiji Abraham
Kochi

Test for Technocrats

I suggest EFY to conduct a technical test for the technocrats nationally. This will help those who are doing research work in various fields of electronics.

Anshul C. Kansara
Navsari

Software Codes

The software codes of technical articles published in EFY magazine are provided only in the accompanying CD. I request EFY to provide all the codes online. I have subscribed to EFY magazine online, but could not find the subscription number after login to this site. Please tell me where can I find it.

Gerard Canekeeratne
Oman

EFY: Thanks for pointing out an area for improvement. We have taken up this project, and it will be implemented

very soon. Subscription numbers are currently not available on the website.

Designing Low-Power Products

Thanks for publishing the article series 'Designing Low-power Products Using MSP430 Microcontrollers' in January and February issues. I request you to publish a similar kind of article series on Cypress CY3270 and Texas Instruments' MSP430RF2500 microcontrollers.

I also suggest you to provide a reference booklet on MSP430F2013, CY3270, Atmega16 and MSP430RF2500 instruction sets and pin configurations with EFY magazine every quarter. It would be useful to hobbyists, students and professionals in working on projects or preparing for interviews.

Maneesh Sharma
Navi Mumbai

Circuit Ideas of Anniversary Issue

I have been a regular reader of EFY for many years. In January issue, I have noticed that:

1. In 'Running LED Lights' circuit, a 12V transformer has been used. I feel a 7.5V or 9V transformer will be a better choice for logical and economical reasons.

2. In 'Top 10 Circuits,' two emergency light circuits and two 3-phase application circuits have been included, which are electrical in nature. You should publish a variety of circuits for different readers.

Rakesh P.
Through e-mail

EFY: Thanks for your feedback and interest in EFY magazine. As regards your observations:

1. Use of a 12V transformer in the 'Running LED Light' circuit is alright in a hobbyist circuit design. Optimisation can always be done by the users for whatever reason they may think appropriate.

2. The two emergency light circuits are quite different and these were chosen based on the readers' feedback on EFY website. The automatic phase changer is designed for balancing the loads on different phases and also for

DTH TV

The article titled 'Which DTH TV for You?' published in February issue, was authored by Amit Goel, with some inputs from Uma Bansal. We are sorry, Mr Goel's name was inadvertently left out as author of the article.

Mr Goel has several years' experience in the field and runs his own blog, which can be seen at "<http://amitslab.com/blog>"

providing supply to essential loads in the event of failure of a particular phase, whereas the three-phase appliance protector provides supply to the appliance only when all the three phase are available. Notwithstanding the foregoing, selection of these two circuits was also based on the readers' feedback.

Heart Rate Meter

Regarding the 'Microcontroller-based Heart Rate Meter' project published in May 2008 issue, I have the following queries:

1. In the software program, it is mentioned that time is noted down after the end of three crossings. Are these three crossings related to P, R, T waves? In practice, while measuring ECG, the ECG waveform also consists of time period after 'T' wave of the first ECG and before 'P' wave of the second ECG waveform. Thus the time should be read before 'P' wave of the next ECG.

2. The time taken from time-count register is converted in terms of the number of 4ms intervals. I don't understand why 4ms interval is taken?

3. How can I stop the ambient light from interfering with the readings?

Ms Amruta Pise
Mumbai

The author Prof. K Padmanabhan replies:

1. Do not confuse ECG with the blood flow signal into the finger. It is just the blood flow signal that is used for counting here. Refer to the waveform shown in the article.

2. You can use any unit for measuring time, provided you know the basic unit; just as you can measure weight in grams or kilograms, depending on the measured value.